

City General Hospital — Official Policy Handbook

1. Visitor Policy

- **General Wards:** Visiting hours are strictly enforced from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM daily.
- **Intensive Care Unit (ICU):** ICU visiting hours are limited to two specific windows: 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM and 5:00 PM to 7:00 PM.
- **Visitor Limits:** A maximum of two visitors per patient are permitted at any given time.
- **Overnight Stays:** One overnight family member is permitted in private rooms only with prior approval from the attending nursing supervisor.
- **Health Guidelines:** Visitors showing symptoms of contagious illnesses (fever, cough, cold) are strictly prohibited from entering patient care areas.

2. Patient Admission & Discharge

- **Emergency Admission:** Emergency care services are available 24/7 and do not require prior insurance approval before initial treatment.
- **Elective / Non-Emergency Admission:** Planned non-emergency procedures require prior insurance authorization at least 48 hours before scheduled admission.
- **Discharge Timing:** Standard patient discharge processing occurs daily between 10:00 AM and 12:00 PM.
- **Transportation:** Patients undergoing procedures involving anesthesia or sedation must have an adult companion to escort them home upon discharge.

3. Billing, Insurance, & Refunds

- **Insurance Coverage:** City General Hospital accepts major insurance providers, including Blue Cross, Cigna, Medicare, and UnitedHealthcare.
- **Out-of-Pocket Expenses:** Co-payments and deductibles are due at the time of service or discharge.
- **Payment Plans:** Flexible monthly payment plans are available through the Patient Financial Services office for uninsured or underinsured patients.
- **Refund Policy:** Hospital service fees, diagnostic fees, and medication costs are non-refundable once services are rendered. Billing disputes must be submitted in writing within 60 days of invoice date.

4. Patient Privacy & Records Access

- **HIPAA Compliance:** Patient medical records, treatment plans, and diagnostic results are strictly confidential under HIPAA guidelines.
- **Medical Record Requests:** Patients can request copies of their medical records through the Health Information Management (HIM) office. Processing takes 3 to 5 business days.
- **Family Updates:** Patient condition updates are provided only to designated primary contacts listed on the patient's HIPAA authorization form.

5. Prescription & Medication Safety

- **Outside Medications:** Patients are prohibited from taking personal medications brought from home unless specifically evaluated and approved by the hospital pharmacy.
- **Opioid Prescriptions:** Prescription refills for controlled substances and opioids require an in-person follow-up appointment and will not be issued over the phone.